

# Influence of Student Club Participation on Academic Performance and Student Development

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**Abstract** - In present day higher education which has seen a great growth in out of class room student involvement a trend which we see in the increased attention put out to co curricular activities like student organizations. At Chitkara we look at the results of student club involvement in terms of academic performance and overall growth of the student. We used a standardized questionnaire which we gave to the undergraduates to collect primary data.

Active members in a club and non involved parties made up the 2 groups of our study. In terms of academic achievement (CGPA), communication skills, confidence, team work, and time management which we looked at, they are very important. Also we looked at the association of which measures of the two groups associated with the mentioned indicators which we analyzed through descriptive and comparative methods.

Students' which is reported in the study do better in terms of collaboration, communication and confidence which is a result of their involvement in clubs. Also many report improved time management and higher productivity which in turn is a fact that school based organizations do not negatively affect academic performance. The report also brings out the value of structured extra curricular activities which the institution puts in place. That which the study reports is a balanced engagement in co curricular and academic activities which in turn improves academic performance as well as personal growth.

**Keywords** - Extracurricular Participation, Academic Performance, Student Engagement, Skill Development, Student Development

## I. INTRODUCTION

In recent years higher education institutions have broadened their focus from academic success to the holistic development of students. Universities now consider experiential learning, leadership development and improved interpersonal skills as key to student development.

Student clubs have become a way to encourage engagement outside the classroom. These clubs provide learners with opportunities to participate in cultural, technical and social activities, meet with their peers, explore interests and assume leadership roles. This engagement can help students develop required skills such as teamwork, communication and time management. The Office of Student Life at Chitkara University plays a vital role in enabling and assisting these student-led initiatives.

Despite the advantages, there is an ongoing debate about the effects of student club involvement on academic performance. Some believe that taking part in co-curricular activities increases motivation,

productivity, and skill development, while others feel that too much engagement can pull Chitkarians away from their academic duties. This issue remains relevant, particularly in Universities like Chitkara University where student engagement is actively promoted.

The purpose of this study is to investigate the impact of student club involvement on academic achievement and the holistic development of individuals. Data for this study were collected through a structured questionnaire administered to undergraduate students across multiple departments at Chitkara University and a comparative analysis was done between Chitkarians who actively participate in clubs and those who do not. The research emphasizes key factors including academic achievement, communication skills, self-confidence, cooperation and time management. This research aims to shed light on the contribution of student clubs to academic success and personal development using a data-driven approach.

## II. LITERATURE REVIEW

Student involvement in extracurricular activities has been recognized as an important factor in student development in higher education. Alexander Astin's theory of student involvement [1] states that students involved in both academic and co-curricular activities tend to have better learning outcomes and higher levels of personal development. The theory emphasizes the role of time and effort dedicated to educationally purposeful activities.

Also, George D. Kuh [2] found student engagement to be a crucial factor for academic success and institutional retention. His research demonstrates a positive impact of campus-based activity participation on cognitive development, interpersonal skills and greater sense of belonging among students.

Further research has shown that extracurricular activities help improve important soft skills like communication, teamwork, and self-confidence [3]. Students who participate in organized activities can often use their theoretical knowledge in real-world situations. This involvement enhances their overall learning experience and better prepares them for professional settings.

However, not all findings are positive. Some studies show that too much involvement in extracurricular activities can lead to time management challenges and more academic pressure [4]. This indicates that while participating is helpful, finding a balance between academic duties and extracurricular activities is important for the best results.

In the context of Indian higher education, research specifically on structured student club systems is still limited. While current studies recognize the benefits of extracurricular engagement, there is not enough evidence assessing its direct impact on academic performance and student growth within institutional settings. Therefore, this study aims to add to the existing knowledge by providing a data-driven analysis based on responses from students at Chitkara University.

### **III. RESEARCH GAP**

Despite the increasing interest in extracurricular activities and student engagement, there are still some important gaps. Many studies in this area are limited in the context of Indian higher education. This is especially true for research based on direct data from students.

Additionally, focused research on student club systems managed by institutional bodies, like the Office of Student Life, is lacking. Many studies also fail to clearly compare students who participate in clubs with those who do not. This

limits our understanding of how involvement affects students. Another major issue is that past research often looks at academic performance or skill development separately, instead of considering both at the same time. This gap is especially important at Chitkara University, where structured student engagement is strongly encouraged.

The current study aims to fill these gaps by using a survey-based approach. It will provide a data-driven comparison of student club participation and its impact on academic performance and personal growth.

### **IV. OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY**

The goals of this study are to look at the academic and personal outcomes linked to student club engagement. The main goals are:

1. To study how student club engagement affects academic performance.
2. To compare the academic results of students who take part in clubs with those who do not.
3. To explore how club participation influences communication skills and confidence.
4. To evaluate the impact of student club involvement on teamwork and time management skills.

### **V. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY**

#### **A. RESEARCH DESIGN**

This study uses a straightforward quantitative approach to explore how joining student clubs connects to academic success and personal growth. We put together a survey and collected responses directly from students so we could compare club members with those who aren't involved.

#### **B. DATA COLLECTION**

We gathered data using a structured questionnaire on Google Forms, sent out to undergraduate students from different departments at Chitkara University. The survey focused on close-ended questions—mostly multiple choice and Likert scales—to track things like academic performance, engagement, and skill development.

#### **C. SAMPLE SIZE**

We ended up with 111 valid responses from students across all academic years and fields. That gives us a pretty diverse sample to work with.

## D. SAMPLING TECHNIQUE

For this project, we went with convenience sampling. Basically, students who were easy to reach and willing to take the survey made up our participants. It's a common way to go for exploratory studies within universities.

## E. VARIABLES CONSIDERED

We looked at both academic and developmental factors. Academic performance is measured by CGPA, and personal development covers things like communication skills, confidence, teamwork, and time management. Students rated themselves on these areas using a Likert scale.

## F. TOOLS FOR ANALYSIS

All the data landed in Microsoft Excel for analysis. We leaned on descriptive stats—like percentage breakdowns and comparisons between groups—to make sense of it. To showcase the results, we have made bar graphs and pie charts so the results are easy to see and understand.

## VI. DATA ANALYSIS AND INTERPRETATION

The collected data from a total of 111 respondents was analyzed to examine the relationship between student club participation and academic performance as well as personal development indicators.

### A. PARTICIPATION OVERVIEW

The survey results indicate that a significant majority of respondents (approximately 87.4%) are actively involved in student clubs, while only 12.6% reported no participation in extracurricular activities. This reflects a high level of student engagement within the university and provides a strong basis for comparative analysis.

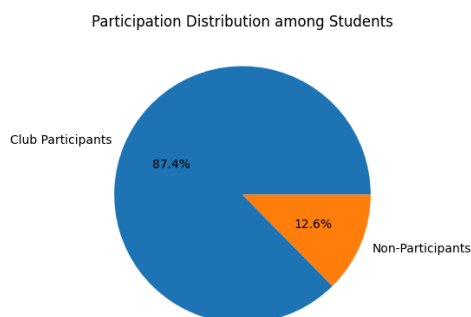


Fig. 1: Participation Distribution among Students

### B. ACADEMIC PERFORMANCE

An analysis of academic performance shows that students maintain strong academic outcomes regardless of their involvement in clubs. Approximately 45.9% of respondents fall within the CGPA range of 9.0 and above, followed by 29.7% in the 8.0–8.99 range, and 16.2% in the 7.0–7.99 range. Only a very small percentage of students reported CGPA below 7.0.

The findings suggest that participation in student clubs does not negatively impact academic performance. Instead, students are able to maintain stable academic results while engaging in extracurricular activities, indicating effective balance between academic and non-academic commitments.

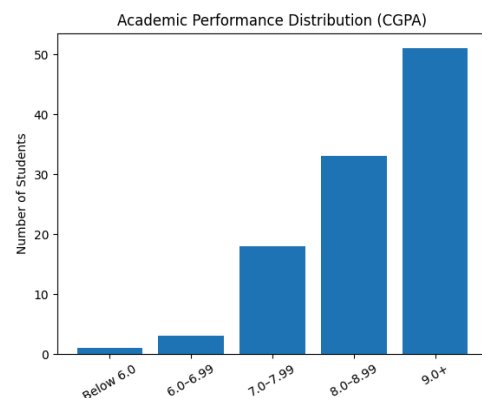


Fig. 2: Academic Performance Distribution (CGPA)

### C. CONFIDENCE LEVELS

Responses indicate that students involved in club activities demonstrate higher confidence levels. The average confidence score among respondents was approximately 4.2 out of 5, indicating a high level of self-confidence. Additionally, around 75–80% of students rated their confidence levels at 4 or above on the scale. Participation in events, leadership roles, and public speaking opportunities contributes significantly to this improvement.

### D. COMMUNICATION SKILLS

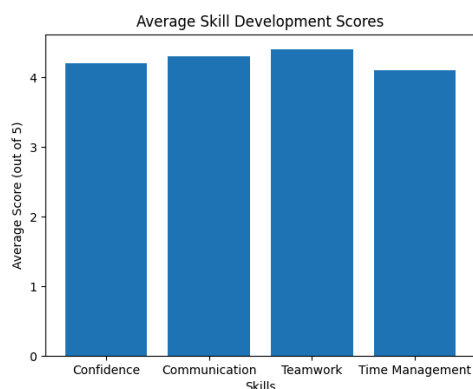
Student club participation has a strong positive influence on communication skills. The average score for communication skills was approximately 4.3 out of 5. Nearly 80% of respondents reported improvement in their ability to express ideas, engage in discussions, and interact effectively with peers. This enhancement is largely attributed to regular involvement in presentations, discussions, and collaborative activities.

## E. TEAMWORK AND COLLABORATION

The findings suggest that students actively participating in clubs exhibit strong teamwork and collaboration skills. The average teamwork score was approximately 4.4 out of 5, which is the highest among all measured skill indicators. Around 82–85% of respondents agreed that their ability to work in teams improved due to club participation. Group-based activities and event management responsibilities contribute to the development of coordination, cooperation, and leadership abilities.

## F. TIME MANAGEMENT

Students involved in extracurricular activities reported improved time management skills. The average score for time management was approximately 4.1 out of 5. About 70–75% of respondents agreed that participation in student clubs helped them manage their academic workload and extracurricular responsibilities more effectively. This indicates that involvement in clubs promotes better planning and productivity rather than causing academic disruption.



*Fig. 3: Average Skill Development Scores among Students*

Overall, the analysis demonstrates that student club participation contributes positively to personal development, including confidence, communication, teamwork, and time management, while maintaining stable academic performance.

## VII. DISCUSSION

This study shows that getting involved in student clubs really helps—not just with grades, but with personal growth, too. We looked at survey responses from 111 students, and most are pretty active in extracurriculars. It's clear: learners at Chitkara university aren't just showing up to class; they're really diving into campus life.

A lot of people think joining clubs means your grades will suffer, but the numbers say otherwise. Nearly half of the students—45.9%—have a CGPA of 9.0 or higher. So, being involved outside the classroom doesn't drag down their academic performance; if anything, it goes hand-in-hand with doing well.

Chitkarians also say they've seen real growth in themselves—confidence, communication, teamwork, handling their time, all that good stuff. On a 5-point scale, the average scores for these traits landed between 4.1 and 4.4. That's a strong endorsement for club involvement, especially since these are skills that matter both now and later on in the working world.

What's interesting is how these results match up with what educational theorists like Alexander W. Astin and George D. Kuh have been saying for years: students who engage more end up learning and developing more. Active involvement isn't just a buzzword—it actually pays off.

In short, student clubs aren't a distraction. They're a big part of what helps students grow and succeed. Of course, finding the right balance between schoolwork and outside commitments matters, but when you do, it all adds up to a well-rounded university experience.

## VIII. CONCLUSION

The study finds that getting involved in student clubs actually helps students grow, and doesn't mess up their grades. Turns out, you can keep your academic performance strong even when you're busy with extracurriculars.

But there's more to it. Students in clubs pick up all kinds of practical skills—like communicating better, building confidence, working with others, and figuring out how to manage their time. Those abilities matter in school and wherever you end up after graduation.

Researchers stress that universities should put effort into creating opportunities for students to join clubs. It's not just about having fun; it's about preparing them for life outside the classroom and giving them the tools to handle real-world situations.

## IX. FUTURE SCOPE

This study sheds light on how joining student clubs affects students. Still, there's a lot left to explore. Researchers should look at more universities next time—casting a wider net helps make the findings matter to more people. If you boost the sample size, the results get sturdier too.

Also, it's worth digging in with sharper tools: regression analysis or correlation models could help map out exactly how student engagement connects to their academic performance. And let's not stop there. Why not track how these club experiences shape students' careers, employability, and long-term professional growth? That kind of research fills in the bigger picture about what extracurriculars really mean for students in higher education.

## **X. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT**

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